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By Francesca Micheletti · Jul 14, 2026, 12:31 PM · [View in your browser](#)

BRUSSELS — The European Commission is mulling adjustments to the Foreign Subsidies Regulation, the bloc's tool for detecting whether companies in the internal market are unfairly backed by foreign governments.

The EU executive took stock of the first three years of enforcement of the FSR in a report published on Tuesday that concluded the tool was broadly "fit for purpose."

It is nevertheless planning tweaks to take into account feedback it's received, namely on the large administrative burden that the regulation imposes on companies.

The FSR applies to companies either making acquisitions or taking part in public procurement procedures across the bloc when the value of deals hits certain thresholds. The two legs are run respectively by the Commission's competition and industry departments.

For mergers, the Commission may consider adjusting the thresholds to catch fewer deals, while introducing a simplified track for certain types of cases. It could also "moderately" increase reporting thresholds for public funding received abroad, according to a press release accompanying the report.

On the public procurement front, the Commission is considering a simpler form for notification and limits to the information that companies need to produce on their foreign funding, as well as some procedural tweaks aimed at making the process smoother.

In its first three years of application, the Commission has received just under 300 merger notifications and only three underwent an in-depth investigation. It has received some 5,000 submissions under the public procurement tool and launched four in-depth investigations.

It also opened two in-depth probes on its own initiative, into airport security scanner maker Nuctech and wind turbine maker Goldwind.

The proposed adjustments will be published in the autumn, the Commission said, with a view to adoption in 2027.

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